

Tarrytown vs. Westlake Hills: Which Austin Neighborhood Fits Your Family?

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THE SHORT ANSWER

Tarrytown offers a shorter downtown commute (10-15 minutes), Austin ISD's Casis Elementary zone, and a more urban residential character starting around \$1.2M. Westlake Hills offers Eanes ISD, larger lots, and a 20-45 minute commute, starting around \$850K.

Every relocation buyer and every move-up family eventually asks some version of the same question: Tarrytown or Westlake? It's usually not a casual question — it's the fork in the road that determines the next decade of school pickups, commute times, and Saturday mornings.

Both are considered among Austin's premier addresses. Both attract buyers who could afford to live almost anywhere in the city and have chosen these two specific places on purpose.

The Short Version

Tarrytown means Austin ISD's Casis Elementary zone, a 10-15 minute downtown commute, and a more urban, walkable residential character on smaller, established lots. Westlake Hills means Eanes ISD — widely regarded as the strongest public school district in Texas — a 20-45 minute commute, and larger lots with more Hill Country privacy. Rollingwood offers Eanes ISD zoning at a meaningfully lower price point than Westlake Hills proper.

School District: Casis Elementary vs. Eanes ISD

Tarrytown falls within Austin ISD, and most of the neighborhood is zoned to Casis Elementary — the single most sought-after elementary assignment within Austin ISD, feeding into O. Henry Middle School and Austin High School.

Westlake Hills and Rollingwood fall entirely within Eanes Independent School District, consistently ranking among the top public school districts in Texas. Casis Elementary is the best AISD has to offer; Eanes ISD as a whole district is what draws families to Westlake and Rollingwood.

Commute: The Trade-Off Most Buyers Underestimate

Tarrytown sits just west of downtown Austin — a genuine 10-15 minute drive to the urban core at peak hours. Westlake Hills and Rollingwood sit farther west, beyond MoPac, with a commute typically running 20-45 minutes depending on address. Rollingwood, closer to MoPac, generally commutes faster than deep Westlake Hills addresses.

Price and Lot Character

Tarrytown prices in 2026 typically range from \$1.2M to \$4M+, on smaller, established lots close to downtown. Westlake Hills runs roughly \$850K to \$5M+, generally on larger lots with more topographical variation. Rollingwood offers the most accessible entry point into Eanes ISD, typically \$900K to \$1.5M.

Lifestyle: Urban-Adjacent vs. Hill Country Private

Daily life in Tarrytown leans urban-adjacent — walkable pockets, a short drive to downtown, Lake Austin access. Daily life in Westlake Hills and Rollingwood leans toward Hill Country privacy — more space, greenbelt access, a pace organized around schools and the surrounding landscape.

Which Buyer Fits Which Neighborhood

Tarrytown fits buyers who work downtown, want walkability and central-Austin character, and for whom Casis Elementary combined with a short commute outweighs the broadest district guarantee. Westlake Hills fits buyers for whom the entire Eanes pipeline is the priority and who are willing to trade commute time for it. Rollingwood fits buyers who want Eanes ISD at a more accessible price and shorter commute than Westlake Hills proper.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Is Tarrytown or Westlake Hills better for schools?

Westlake Hills and Rollingwood are zoned to Eanes ISD, widely considered the strongest public school district in Texas across the entire K-12 pipeline. Tarrytown is zoned to Austin ISD's Casis Elementary, the most sought-after elementary assignment within AISD. Eanes offers district-wide consistency; Casis offers a standout elementary school within a larger district.

What is the commute like from Westlake Hills to downtown Austin?

Commutes typically run 20 to 45 minutes depending on address and time of day. Rollingwood, being closer to MoPac, generally commutes faster than deep Westlake Hills addresses. Tarrytown offers a 10 to 15 minute downtown commute from most addresses.

Is Rollingwood cheaper than Westlake Hills?

Yes, generally. Rollingwood offers the most accessible entry into Eanes ISD, typically \$900,000 to \$1.5 million, compared to Westlake Hills' broader \$850,000 to \$5 million+ range, and is also closer to MoPac for a shorter commute.

How much do homes cost in Tarrytown vs. Westlake Hills?

Tarrytown ranges from \$1.2 million to \$4 million+ on smaller, established lots close to downtown. Westlake Hills ranges from roughly \$850,000 to \$5 million+, generally on larger lots. Compare address-by-address rather than neighborhood-by-neighborhood.

Should I choose Tarrytown or Westlake Hills for my family?

Choose Tarrytown if a short downtown commute and Casis Elementary matter most. Choose Westlake Hills or Rollingwood if the full Eanes ISD pipeline, space, and privacy matter most and you're willing to accept a longer commute.